

Dr. Michael James Heseltine

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Website: <https://sites.google.com/view/michaelheseltine>

Research Interests Political Communication, Political Institutions, Political Behavior, Electoral Politics, Social Science Methodology, Text Analysis, Machine Learning

Academic Positions **University of Oxford** Oxford, UK
Postdoctoral Researcher (*Department of Sociology*) 2025-Present

University of Amsterdam Amsterdam, NL
Postdoctoral Researcher (*School of Communication Research*) 2022-2025

Education **American University** Washington, DC
PhD, Political Science (*American & Comparative Politics*) 2022
Dissertation: "Persuaded by the Polls: The Effects of Election Polling on Individual Electoral Behavior"
Chair: David Barker, Co-Chair: Andrew Ballard

Freie Universität Berlin Berlin, Germany
MA, North American Studies (*Political Science and Economics*) 2018

University of Sussex Brighton, UK
BA, American Studies and Politics 2014

Publications **AI and Research Methods (Book Chapter)**
Christopher Barrie, Lisa Argyle, James Bisbee, Michael Heseltine, Christopher Lucas, Jon Mellon, Alexis Palmer, Margaret Roberts, Arthur Spirling
Artificial Intelligence, Politics and Political Science, Cambridge University Press, Forthcoming

Measuring Partisanship and Representation in Online Congressional Communication
Michael Kistner, Michael Heseltine, Robert Alvarez, Maya Fitch, Lucas Lothamer, Elizabeth Simas
American Political Science Review, Accepted

Going Local? Local Attentiveness in Congressional Communications
Michael Heseltine
Political Communication, 2025

Believing What Politicians Communicate: Ideological Presentation of Self and Voters' Perceptions of Politician Ideology
Hans Hassell, Michael Heseltine, Kevin Reuning
British Journal of Political Science, 2025

Partisan Temporal Selective News Avoidance: Evidence from Online Trace Data

Michael Heseltine, Hennes Barnehl, Magdalena Wojcieszak
American Journal of Political Science, 2025

Effects of Exposure to Partisan Media and Coverage of Polarization on Perceived Polarization

Michael Heseltine, Magdalena Wojcieszak, Bernhard Clemm, Ericka Menchen-Trevino
Political Communication, 2024

Incentivizing News Consumption on Social Media Platforms Using Large Language Models and Realistic Bot Accounts

Hadi Askari, Anshuman Chhabra, Bernhard Clemm von Hohenberg, Michael Heseltine, Magdalena Wojcieszak
PNAS Nexus, 2024

Large Language Models as a Substitute for Human Experts in Annotating Political Text

Michael Heseltine, Bernhard Clemm von Hohenberg
Research and Politics, 2024

Asymmetric Polarization in Online Media Engagement in the United States Congress

Michael Heseltine
International Journal of Press and Politics, 2023

Polarizing Online Elite Rhetoric at the Federal, State, and Local Level During the COVID-19 Pandemic

Michael Heseltine
American Politics Research, 2023

Assessing Trump's Presidential Endorsements In and Out of Office (2018-2022)

Michael Heseltine
Electoral Studies, 2023

Dynamics of Congressional Incivility on Twitter

Andrew Ballard; Ryan DeTamble, Spencer Dorsey, Michael Heseltine, Marcus Johnson
American Politics Research, 2022

Online Incivility in the 2020 Congressional Elections

Michael Heseltine, Spencer Dorsey
Political Research Quarterly, 2022

Dynamics of Polarizing Rhetoric in Congressional Tweets

Andrew Ballard; Ryan DeTamble, Spencer Dorsey, Michael Heseltine, Marcus Johnson

Legislative Studies Quarterly, 2022

Be Careful What You Wish For: The Impacts of President Trump's Midterm Endorsements

Andrew Ballard, Hans Hassell, Michael Heseltine

Legislative Studies Quarterly, 2021.

Winner of the Jewell-Loewenberg Prize, Best Article in American Politics, 2022

Under Review

Does Quality Still Count? The Decline of Candidate Experience in U.S. Senate Elections, 1980-2022

Revise and Resubmit, Legislative Studies Quarterly

Carlos Algara, Byengseon Bae, Isaac Hale, Edward Headington, Michael Heseltine, & Evan Lieber

AI summaries in social media improve dialogue but reduce engagement

Michael Heseltine, Chris Bail, Petter Törnberg, Michelle Schimmel, Chris Barrie

Branding, Ideology, and Preference Formation in AI Systems: Evidence from a Two-Stage Evaluation and Choice Experiment

Michael Heseltine, Chris Bail, Petter Törnberg, Michelle Schimmel, Chris Barrie

Ideological Differentiation in Parliamentary Systems: MP Messaging Ideology in the UK 2024 General Election

Michael Heseltine, Paul Webb

Comparing Large Language Models for Text Classification: Model Selection Across Tasks, Texts, and Languages

Michael Heseltine

How the Use of Difference-in-Differences Designs and Delayed Treatment Effects Obfuscate Conclusions: Testing for Post Primary Candidate Rhetorical Moderation

Kevin Reuning, Michael Heseltine, Hans Hassell

Targeted Hostility Towards Women in the (Political) Media

Michael Heseltine, Megan Kurten

Political Talk and Political Disagreement in Non-Political Spaces

Joao Goncalves, Michael Heseltine, Anshuman Chabra, Magdalena Wojcieszak

Political Sorting Can Drive AI Models Apart Through User Feedback

Petter Törnberg, Michael Heseltine, Michelle Schimmel, Chris Barrie

Ongoing Projects

Elite-Driven Division? Over Time Changes in Polarizing Elite Rhetorical Strategies Across 42 Countries

Michael Heseltine

The Determinants of Perceptions of Party Brands

Hans Hassell, Michael Heseltine, Kevin Reuning, Ryan Vander Wielen

What You See Is What You Get? Campaign Positioning and In Office Behavior

Michael Heseltine, Hans Hassell, Kevin Reuning

Other Writing

Does a Trump endorsement make a difference? Yes, but not the way a candidate hopes it will

August 2021. [The Conversation](#)

The Limited Power of Trump's Endorsements

July 2021. [Mischiefs of Faction](#)

Was There Partisan Bias in the Local Administration of the 2020 Elections?

November 2020. [Mischiefs of Faction](#)

Teaching Experience

Instructor, Research Seminar: Content Analysis

University of Amsterdam

Spring 2025

Instructor, Research Seminar: Surveys

University of Amsterdam

Spring 2025

Thesis Supervisor, Political Communication Thesis (Research Master)

University of Amsterdam

Spring 2024

Instructor, Methods of Communication Research and Statistics

University of Amsterdam

Fall 2023

Instructor, Gov-310 Intro to Political Research

American University

Spring 2022

Teaching Assistant, Gov-650 Political Analysis

American University

Fall 2019

Teaching Assistant, Gov-321 Congress and Legislative Behavior
American University
Fall 2018

Seminar Instructor, Hist-101 Understanding North America: History
Freie Universität Berlin
Winter 2017

Awards

Jewell-Loewenberg Prize, Best Article in American Politics, 2022
APSA Legislative Studies Division
Be Careful What You Wish For: The Impacts of President Trump's Midterm Endorsements

Outstanding Research Award, Graduate, American University School of Public Affairs
Online Incivility in the 2020 Congressional Elections

Presentations and Invited Talks

"APSA Presidential Taskforce on AI and Research Methods in Political Science"
Ongoing - Invited Member

"Facing AI: Research Opportunities and Challenges in Today's Social Sciences"
University of Oxford - Invited Speaker

"Machine Learning and Large Language Models for Quantitative Text Analysis"
University of Namur - Invited Speaker

"Web Data Donations and Trace Data Collection - Roundtable"
University of Amsterdam - Invited Speaker

American Political Science Association Annual Conference
2025, 2024, 2023, 2022, 2021, 2020, 2019

Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference
2026, 2023, 2022, 2020, 2019

Southern Political Science Association Annual Conference
2022, 2021, 2020, 2019

International Communication Association Annual Conference
2023

References

Prof. Christopher Barrie, Assistant Professor, New York University,
cb5691@nyu.edu

Prof. Magdalena Wojcieszak, Professor, University of California, Davis,
mwojcieszak@ucdavis.edu

Prof. Andrew Ballard, Associate Professor, Florida State University,
aoballard@fsu.edu

Prof. Hans Hassell, Professor, Florida State University,
hans.hassell@gmail.com